

# Riptide music video, Vance Joy (2013)

<http://www.vancejoy.com/video>

**AS Component 1:  
Investigating the Media**  
**A level Component 1: Media Products,  
Industries and Audiences**

**Subject Content: Media Language**  
**Focus Area: Representation,  
Media contexts**

## PRODUCT CONTEXT

- Vance Joy is an Australian singer-songwriter signed to Atlantic records (a subsidiary of major label, Warner). His music can be categorised as fitting into indie folk-pop genre.
- *Riptide* was Vance Joy's first single to be released in the USA, following his debut EP, "God Loves You When You're Dancing". It became a platinum selling single.
- The video was directed by Dimitri Basil and Laura Gorun and has had nearly 100 million views on YouTube.

## PART 1: STARTING POINTS – Media Language

### Economic Contexts:

Consider whether the seemingly low budget, unique style of the music video was an artistic decision or an **economic** one. Later Vance Joy music videos such as "Georgia" make use of larger budgets, special effects and elaborate, coherent narratives. **Funding** could be discussed in relation to music video in terms of the way that bands might start out with small low budget productions which increase in scope and budget as they gain popularity and fans. Consider the extent to which **budget** impacts artistic decisions and the visual **style** of music videos. An extension of this discussion might explore whether music videos are in themselves an **advert** for the band or a representation of how "valuable" the band are to

producers. Are mainstream **audiences** impressed by larger budget music videos and attracted to the apparent implied "quality" of that band?

**Consider how the combination of elements of media language influences meaning and intertextuality:**

- The video makes **intertextual** references to different media forms (see below) and offers a wide variety of seemingly disparate elements.
- **Montage editing** is used in an overt way - a wide range of contrasting shots juxtaposed (often through hard jump cuts) to convey a large amount of information:
  - » The editing together of seemingly disparate images invites audience **interpretation** and candidates could consider Eisenstein's concept of "intellectual montage" where new ideas emerge from the collision of images and generate new meanings that might not otherwise exist:
    - \* For example the sequence where a male and a female suddenly turn their heads to look at something off-screen and the next shot shows a seemingly unrelated pile of dollar bills - consider the **connections** audiences are being asked to make through this use of montage.
    - \* Many of these cuts also have a clear link to the **lyrics** themselves and candidates might explore the visual metaphors and possible significance of these edits in relation to the lyrics.
  - » The music video for the most part rejects a clearly defined **narrative**. There are some short coherent narrative sequences (such as the scene where the girl goes missing in the graveyard) but for the most part the sequences deliberately lack narrative coherence.
  - \* Candidates might explore the way in which the music video seems to reference **surrealist** or avant-garde cinema (such